

The Goal of a Project

What Clients Actually Buy?

We do the business of "Software Engineering" in the form of "Projects" to solve clients' problems; However, we sometimes forget about the real goal of project.

The Real goal of project is **not making code**.

Then, **what is the real goal of a project?**

Who Are the "Clients"?

- **High-Level Leaders:** CEO, CTO
- **Managers & Tech Leads:** your daily audience
- **Product Owners & Sales:** shape and sell the software product
- **Actual Paying Customers:** the ultimate decision-makers

Don't forget

Clients don't buy *code*.

They buy **pain relief, trust, and outcomes**.

You Are a Professional Painkiller

Think beyond “developer.”

Your real job is to deliver **UP ReST**:

- **U**nderstanding
- **P**eace of mind
- Risk **R**eduction
- **S**tatus improvement
- **T**ime recovery

1. Understanding (U)

Clients buy your ability to **translate their real problem.**

- Understand the true goal, not just the request
- Explore the story: how it started, why it matters, who's affected
- Avoid jumping to solutions before seeing the full picture

2. Peace of Mind (P)

Clients want someone **reliable**, not just skilled.

- They want to hand off the problem without drama
- Reliability often matters **more** than perfect code
- Consistency builds long-term trust

3. Risk Reduction (Re)

Clients fear failure—especially reputational risk.

- They worry about looking bad if the project collapses
- Being the “safe choice” is more valuable than being the cheapest
- Quick prototypes reduce uncertainty and fear

4. Status Enhancement (S)

People buy with emotions.

- Clients wonder: "Will this make me look smart?"
- Internal politics matter
- Help them win internally, and you win too

5. Time Recovery (T)

Give clients their time and energy back.

- Reduce their mental load
- Remove the need for constant supervision
- Let them focus on what matters most

Worst Case Scenario

- Keep saying “Everything will be OK” but no real progress
- Not sharing updates
- Giving inaccurate or “white lie” reports
- Blaming others

Best Case Scenario

- Make things OK through consistent action
- Small, steady daily progress
- Honest updates (good or bad)
- Learn from mistakes and prevent repeats

Software Engineers

Software Engineers are professional problem solvers who can give UpREST to clients.

- They solve problems by managing complexity.
- They solve problems using tools and rules.
- They solve problems in a team.
- They gain trust by proving them great problem solvers.

Clients or Stakeholders?

In an Agile project:

- "Stakeholders" is the correct general term
- "Stakeholders" include clients, but also more people

Stakeholders = Everyone who cares about or is affected by the project